

draft 8/10/16

COMMISSION FOR DIVERSITY, INCLUSION AND COMMUNITY RELATIONS

Minutes of Fair Housing Committee Meeting on June 7, 2016

Members present: Dwaigh Tyndall, Sean Jaynes, Sandy Batchelder and Lloyd Gellineau.

Absent: Wes Chin, Ernie Frey and Alex Coleman

Guest: Peter Wilner

The minutes of the May 9, 2016 meeting of the Committee were approved.

There was further discussion of the proposed Fair Housing training in September, to be led by Dwaigh. All Town departments should be required to send a representative. The training would be held on a weekday evening from 6-8PM. Snacks and coffee should be available - Lloyd will look into a budget for this. The plan is to give a basic overview of Fair Housing laws. Long lectures would be avoided, and participants would be asked to answer questions either directly or in breakout groups. Relevant documents to take home and share with others would be provided along with referrals to MCAD and HUD. Query whether Dwaigh should recruit some additional persons to serve as an expert panel?

The venue for the training would be determined by the Town Manager. Dwaigh agreed to prepare an outline of the training to inform the Commission and the Town Manager. Sean would keep the Outreach Committee informed and solicit any needed assistance.

Sandy reported that his review of the existing Bylaw on Fair Housing had identified three issues:

- 1) Changing the references to the Human Relations Commission to CDICR;
- 2) Conforming the definition of persons protected by the Bylaw to the definition of Brookline protected persons recently adopted by the Commission; and
- 3) Conforming the complaint procedure to the procedure for "other" complaints recently adopted by the Commission and being reviewed by the BOS.

Copies of the existing Bylaw would be circulated to the Committee members by Lloyd and they were asked to review it to see if there were other issues that should be addressed. It was suggested that the complaint procedure could be eliminated entirely and complainants referred to MCAD or HUD since only these agencies had authority to take action on Fair Housing complaints. Sandy and Ernie would review these issues and make recommendations at the next meeting.

Discussion of the proposed training and changes to the Fair Housing Bylaw would continue at the next meeting of the Committee, scheduled for Tuesday July 19 at 6:30PM in the small conference room in the basement of the public health building.

Minutes prepared by Sandy Batchelder